

# File Case #1

**Case ID:** 78B **Case Title:** The "Silent Canvas" Case **Date:** October 12, 2008 **Status:** Unsolved (Cold Case)

**Crime Summary:** A robbery was perpetrated at the city's Modern Art Gallery. The stolen artwork was "**Starry Night over the River**," by the acclaimed contemporary painter **Javier Soto**, valued at 3 million euros. The theft occurred overnight, without any of the pressure, motion, or laser alarms sounding.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The thief demonstrated extremely advanced technical knowledge. The alarms were neutralized using a device that emitted a specific sonic frequency, temporarily uncalibrating the sensors without leaving a trace in the system. The armored glass of the display case was cut with a high-precision diamond tool, leaving a **perfect circle**. The perpetrator did not use brute force at any time.

## Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect:** An unidentified individual known by the alias "**El Maestro**" (**The Master**). Believed to be a gentleman thief with experience in high-end security systems. No fingerprints or DNA were obtained.
- **Key Witnesses:** None. The on-duty security guard reported no anomalies.
- **Victim:** The Modern Art Gallery and the private collector who owned the artwork.

## Key Evidence:

- Microscopic fragments of a **quartz crystal** near the display case, possibly from a custom sonic emitter.
- The circular cut in the armored glass, suggesting the use of a specialized, non-commercial tool.
- Security logs corrupted in a **30-minute loop**, precisely during the estimated time of the robbery.

**Forensic Analysis:** Analysis of the quartz crystal did not yield any matches in commercial databases. The lab concluded that the emitter device was likely **homemade** and of a **unique design**. Analysis of the security system revealed that the log corruption was done **remotely**, exploiting a **zero-day vulnerability** in the system's firmware, which was previously unknown.

**Resolution:** The case remains unsolved. The artwork was never recovered, and the identity of "El Maestro" remains a mystery. The case is a **paradigmatic example of high-tech heists**.

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## File Case #2

**Case ID:** 113C **Case Title:** The "Traitor Data" Case **Date:** March 22, 2015 **Status:** Closed

**Crime Summary:** The technology company "**Innovatec Solutions**" reported the theft of the blueprints for their graphene battery prototype. The information was extracted directly from their main server, without any forced physical access. A competitor announced a similar product six months later.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The data theft was executed in two phases. First, a **spear phishing** attack was directed at the head of engineers, using an email impersonating the IT department. Once the victim clicked, a customized malicious software **keylogger**, known as "**GhostKey**," was installed. This malware captured the server access credentials. Subsequently, the perpetrator accessed the system remotely outside of business hours and **exfiltrated the 50 GB** of project data.

### Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect: Julián Reyes**, former Head of Cybersecurity at Innovatec, fired 3 months before the incident due to personnel cuts.
- **Victim:** Innovatec Solutions.

### Key Evidence:

- Network logs showing a massive data transfer to an **overseas IP address**, routed through several proxies.
- Remnants of the "**GhostKey**" malware found on the head engineer's computer. Code analysis revealed **similarities to scripts Reyes had developed** for the company.
- Forensic financial reports discovered a **€250,000 payment** to an offshore account in Reyes' sister's name, two weeks after the theft.

**Forensic Analysis:** The digital forensics team managed to "unmask" one of the proxy layers, linking the initial connection to a **coffee shop two blocks from Julián Reyes' residence**. The "**GhostKey**" malware's signature was unique and contained code fragments Reyes had used in legitimate security tools during his time at the company.

**Resolution:** Julián Reyes was found guilty of **industrial espionage**. The circumstantial evidence (the payment, his network knowledge, the location) coupled with the digital evidence (code similarities) was sufficient for a conviction. Some of the money was recovered, but the blueprints were never returned.

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## File Case #3

**Case ID:** 45D **Case Title:** The "Thursday Thief" Case **Date:** Spate of robberies between 2011 and 2012 **Status:** Closed

**Crime Summary:** A series of 12 burglaries occurred in the "Los Altos" residential neighborhood. All robberies happened on **Thursday nights**, and the target was always high-net-worth residences. The thief only stole small, easily transportable items: **jewelry, luxury watches, and cash**.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The perpetrator operated with a very **consistent pattern**. They avoided front doors and gained access by **forcing second-story windows**, usually in bathrooms or studies. They acted quickly, focusing on master bedrooms. They showed no interest in art or electronics. At every crime scene, they left a single **domino tile, always the double three**.

### Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect: Marco "El Rápido" (The Fast) Jiménez**, a petty thief with a history of larceny and a known gambling addiction.
- **Victim(s):** Multiple families in the "Los Altos" neighborhood.

### Key Evidence:

- The **consistent pattern** of the day (Thursday) and entry method (second-floor window).
- The **domino tile "signature"** (double three) left at every scene.
- Footprints of a **cheap-brand athletic shoe** found at several of the robberies.
- Testimony from an informant who claimed Jiménez was trying to sell a limited-edition **Rolex watch** matching one of the stolen items.

**Forensic Analysis:** Analysis of the domino tiles determined they all came from the **same manufacturer and likely the same batch**, bought from a discount store downtown. Analysis of the shoe prints confirmed they corresponded to the **same pair of sneakers** at at least 7 of the scenes.

**Resolution:** Marco Jiménez was placed under surveillance and **arrested** while attempting to sell several of the stolen jewels at a pawn shop. He confessed to the robberies, explaining that Thursday was the day of the week he had the largest gambling debts. The domino tile was a superstition. He was sentenced to prison.

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## File Case #4

**Case ID:** 92A **Case Title:** The "Ghost Fortune" Case **Date:** February 4, 2019 **Status:** Unsolved (Cold Case)

**Crime Summary:** **Ricardo Valbuena**, the Chief Financial Officer (CFO) of the successful family business "**Valbuena & Sons**," disappeared without a trace. A subsequent audit revealed an **embezzlement of over 10 million euros** over three years. It is believed the disappearance was planned, and he fled the country with the money.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The embezzlement was carried out through a complex network of **shell corporations** registered in tax havens. Valbuena created **fake invoices** for "consulting services" to these companies, which he then authorized himself. The money was moved through **multiple accounts** to make tracking difficult.

### Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect: Ricardo Valbuena.**
- **Victim:** The company "Valbuena & Sons" and his family.

### Key Evidence:

- Forensic accounting reports detailing the **money trail**.
- An **encrypted hard drive** found in his office, which could not be decrypted.
- Valbuena's car was found in the **long-stay airport parking lot**. Inside, there was a **partially burned passport** in his name.
- There are **no records** of Ricardo Valbuena boarding any commercial flight that day or the days following.

**Forensic Analysis:** Analysis of the vehicle showed no signs of violence. The **burned passport** was interpreted as an attempt to make people believe he had been the victim of a crime to buy time. Experts believe he likely used a **false identity** and traveled on a private flight or by sea.

**Resolution:** The case remains unsolved. Despite an international arrest warrant, **Ricardo Valbuena was never located**. The money was not recovered. The leading theory is that he is living in a non-extradition country under a new identity.

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## File Case #5

**Case ID:** 301F **Case Title:** The "Digital Ransom" Case **Date:** May 3, 2021 **Status:** Closed (Partial Resolution)

**Crime Summary:** The **Metropolitan Central Hospital** suffered a massive cyberattack. A **ransomware** known as "**Cerberus**" encrypted all patient records, appointment systems, and internal databases, paralyzing the hospital. The attackers demanded a **50 Bitcoin ransom**.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The entry point to the hospital network was a **vulnerable IoT (Internet of Things) device**: a **smart thermostat** in a break room that had not been updated. From there, the hackers **escalated privileges** to reach the main server. The "**Cerberus**" ransomware was a new variant, designed to propagate quickly in medical networks.

### Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect:** A hacker collective known as "**Digital Phantoms**," famous for attacks on critical infrastructure.
- **Victim:** Metropolitan Central Hospital.

### Key Evidence:

- Network traffic analysis that identified the initial **breach through the thermostat's IP**.
- The **Bitcoin wallet address** to which the payment was demanded.
- Fragments of the "**Cerberus**" ransomware code that contained a digital signature similar to that used by "Digital Phantoms" in previous attacks.

**Forensic Analysis:** Analysis of the cryptocurrency wallet revealed that the funds were moved through multiple "**mixers**" to obfuscate their origin. However, a small initial **test transaction** was traced to an exchange that required **KYC (Know Your Customer)**, revealing the identity of a **low-level member** of the group in Eastern Europe.

**Resolution:** The hospital chose not to pay the ransom and, with the help of experts, was able to **restore most of its systems** from backups. The identified member of "Digital Phantoms" was arrested, but the group's leaders were never caught. It is considered a **partial resolution**.

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## File Case #6

**Case ID:** 55G **Case Title:** The "Factory in Ashes" Case **Date:** November 18, 2017 **Status:** Closed

**Crime Summary:** A textile factory on the outskirts of the city was completely **destroyed by a fire** during the night. The owner, **Alberto Ríos**, attributed it to an electrical fault and filed a **€5 million insurance claim**.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The fire was **intentional (arson)**. The perpetrator used a **potassium-based chemical accelerant** that burns at high temperatures and leaves very little residue, making detection difficult. The fire was started in the **meter room** to simulate a short circuit.

### Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect: Alberto Ríos**, the factory owner.
- **Victim:** The insurance company "**Fortuna Seguros**."

### Key Evidence:

- Fire department experts' report indicating **multiple points of fire origin**, inconsistent with an electrical fault.
- Financial analysis showing the factory was **on the verge of bankruptcy** and that Alberto Ríos had massive **gambling debts**.
- Testimony from a fired employee who claimed to have seen **Ríos removing boxes** from the factory days before the fire.
- Residue of the potassium-based accelerant found in a fire-protected corner, identified via **gas chromatography**.

**Forensic Analysis:** The laboratory confirmed that the accelerant was a **specialized mixture used in the metallurgical industry**, a sector in which Ríos had worked before opening the textile factory. This connected the suspect to the specific means used in the crime.

**Resolution:** Confronted with the forensic and financial evidence, **Alberto Ríos confessed** to starting the fire to collect the insurance. He was convicted of **fraud and arson**.

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## File Case #7

**Case ID:** 12H **Case Title:** The "New Dawn Cult" Case **Date:** June 7, 2013 **Status:** Unsolved (Cold Case)

**Crime Summary:** **Laura Campos**, a 20-year-old university student, disappeared. Her family and friends reported that in the preceding months, her behavior had changed drastically after joining a "personal development" group called "**La Secta del Nuevo Amanecer**" (**The New Dawn Cult**). She cut ties with all her acquaintances and emptied her bank account.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The group practiced techniques of **indoctrination and isolation**. They recruited young people during moments of vulnerability. The process included **information control, sleep deprivation**, and creating a strong **emotional and financial dependence** on the group's leader.

### **Persons of Interest:**

- **Main Suspect:** The group's leader, a charismatic man who called himself "**El Guía**" (**The Guide**). His true identity is unknown.
- **Victim:** Laura Campos and other potential members.

### **Key Evidence:**

- Laura's **diary**, which described the indoctrination process.
- Text messages where she said goodbye to her family, with a **language and tone that did not seem like hers**.
- The group operated from an **isolated rural estate**, but **suddenly moved** after the initial police investigations.

**Forensic Analysis:** Not applicable in the traditional sense. Psychological analysis of Laura's writings confirmed a pattern of **coercive manipulation**. Financial tracing showed that the money in her account was **withdrawn in cash in small amounts**.

**Resolution:** The case remains unsolved. It was **impossible to prove a kidnapping**, as Laura technically left "voluntarily." The estate was found empty, and neither "El Guía" nor the cult members, including Laura, have been located.

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## File Case #8

**Case ID:** 88I **Case Title:** The "Perfect Paper Currency" Case **Date:** February 14, 2020

**Status:** Closed (Local cell dismantled)

**Crime Summary:** A surge of extremely **high-quality fake €50 banknotes** flooded the city, causing alarm in the banking and commercial sectors. The banknotes passed most standard detection tests.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The counterfeiters used **high-quality cotton paper** (possibly stolen from a security paper factory) and **offset and intaglio printing techniques** that replicated security features, including the security thread and watermark, almost perfectly. The banknotes were introduced into circulation by making **small purchases in businesses**.

### **Persons of Interest:**

- **Main Suspect:** A counterfeiter known by the alias **"El Impresor" (The Printer)**.
- **Collaborators:** A network of **"passers"** who distributed the money.

### **Key Evidence:**

- Microscopic analysis of the banknotes revealed a **minuscule imperfection in the micro-printing of the hologram**, consistent across all fake banknotes.
- Surveillance of businesses that reported fake banknotes led to the **identification of several "passers."**
- The paper used, while high quality, had a **slightly different chemical composition** from legal tender paper, detectable with spectrometry.

**Forensic Analysis:** Chemical analysis of the paper and ink allowed their origin to be traced to a **specific batch of imported printing supplies from Asia**. The imperfection in the hologram served as a **digital fingerprint** to connect all the banknotes to a **single printing plate**.

**Resolution:** Following the trail of the "passers" led to a **clandestine printing press** in an industrial park. Three people were arrested, and the machinery and over **€2 million in fake banknotes** were seized. "El Impresor," the mastermind of the operation, was not found in the raid and remains at large.

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## File Case #9

**Case ID:** 142J **Case Title:** The "Double Sapphire" Case **Date:** September 29, 2016 **Status:** Closed

**Crime Summary:** Two identical sapphires, "**The Eyes of the Ocean**," were stolen from the luxury jewelry store "**Gemas Preciosas**" (**Precious Gems**). The thieves managed to access the main vault and a **hidden secondary safe** whose existence was almost secret.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The team of thieves operated with **military precision**. They knew the **blind spots of the cameras**, the **exact time of the guards' rounds**, and the **seismic alarm override code**. The key to success was their **knowledge of the secondary safe**, which was not listed in the official security blueprints. This clearly indicated the involvement of an **insider or a former employee**.

### Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect (Insider): Leo Vargas**, a former security guard fired for misconduct six months prior.
- **Suspects (Team):** A gang of professional thieves of **Balkan origin**.

### Key Evidence:

- Access logs showing the vault system was deactivated with a **maintenance code known only to three people, including Vargas**.
- Phone records linking **Leo Vargas** to known members of the Balkan gang in the weeks leading up to the robbery.
- One of the sapphires appeared on the **black market in Antwerp**, and the seller was tracked to an associate of the gang.

**Forensic Analysis:** No physical evidence was found at the scene, as the thieves were extremely careful. The investigation focused almost entirely on **human intelligence and data analysis** (phone and financial records).

**Resolution:** **Leo Vargas was arrested** and, in exchange for a reduced sentence, **confessed** to providing all the security information to the gang for a percentage. Most of the team was arrested in an international operation. One of the two sapphires was recovered.

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## File Case #10

**Case ID:** 211K **Case Title:** The "Compromising File" Case **Date:** January 10, 2022 **Status:** Unsolved (Cold Case)

**Crime Summary:** A high-profile politician, a mayoral candidate, reported being the victim of **blackmail**. An anonymous individual obtained **compromising personal emails and financial documents** and threatened to publish them unless the politician withdrew from the election race.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The attacker used a combination of **social engineering and hacking**. First, they gathered personal information about the politician from **open sources**. Then, they used that information to answer security questions and **reset the password** for his personal email account, which **did not have two-factor authentication** enabled.

### Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect:** An individual or group operating under the alias "**Casio**." Suspected to be an operative working for the **rival campaign**.
- **Victim:** The mayoral candidate.

### Key Evidence:

- The blackmail emails, sent through an **encrypted and anonymous email service**.
- Email provider logs showing a successful login from a **Tor network**, making IP tracing impossible.
- The specific **language and information** used in the blackmail suggested a **deep knowledge of the internal dynamics** of the political campaign.

**Forensic Analysis:** Digital analysis was **unable to trace the blackmailer**. The investigation was reoriented toward the **rival campaign's inner circle**, looking for potential leaks or individuals with the skills and motive, but no conclusive evidence was found.

**Resolution:** The case is unsolved. The politician **refused to give in to the blackmail**, the information was leaked to the press, and he lost the election. The identity of "Casio" was never discovered.

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## File Case #11

**Case ID:** 33L **Case Title:** The "Bitter Pill" Case **Date:** July 25, 2014 **Status:** Unsolved (Cold Case)

**Crime Summary:** Several cases of **severe poisoning** were reported in the city. The investigation determined the cause was the **adulteration of a popular over-the-counter analgesic, "Nodolor."** Someone had bought bottles from different pharmacies, replaced the contents of some capsules with **cyanide**, and returned them to the shelves.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The criminal acted **stealthily and randomly** to maximize panic. The tampered bottles showed **no obvious signs of alteration**. The goal did not seem to be to kill specific people, but to **create terror** and damage the reputation of the manufacturing pharmaceutical company.

### **Persons of Interest:**

- **Main Suspect:** Unknown. Theorized to be a **resentful former employee** of the pharmaceutical company or an unscrupulous competitor.
- **Victim(s):** 3 deceased and 8 hospitalized.

### **Key Evidence:**

- Contaminated **"Nodolor" batches**, found in 5 different pharmacies.
- Security footage from the pharmacies showed hundreds of customers. It was impossible to isolate a single suspect who visited all locations.
- A **note sent to a local newspaper** claiming the act in the name of "justice against corporate greed."

**Forensic Analysis:** Analysis of the **cyanide yielded no clues** as to its origin, as it is a common industrial chemical. **Graphological analysis** of the note was inconclusive. Investigation of fired employees from the pharmaceutical company did not yield any clear suspects.

**Resolution:** The case remains unsolved. The pharmaceutical company **recalled all product** from the market and introduced new packaging with **triple safety seals**. The perpetrator was never identified, and the attacks ceased as suddenly as they began.

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## File Case #12

**Case ID:** 199M **Case Title:** The "Empty Sarcophagus" Case **Date:** December 1, 2018  
**Status:** Closed

**Crime Summary:** An international smuggling ring was discovered trafficking **Egyptian artifacts stolen from the National Museum**. The artifacts were taken out of the country and sent to private collectors abroad.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The ring used a **designer furniture transport company as a front**. The ancient artifacts (amulets, vessels, statuettes) were concealed in **secret compartments** inside replicas of large, modern furniture. These pieces were sent through **legitimate shipping channels**, passing superficial customs inspections.

### **Persons of Interest:**

- **Main Suspect: Dr. Elena Morales**, a respected art historian and museum curator, who used her position to **falsify inventory records**.
- **Collaborators:** A logistics company and a network of intermediaries in Europe.

### **Key Evidence:**

- An **anonymous tip to Interpol** about a suspicious shipment to Switzerland.
- **High-intensity X-rays at customs** that revealed dense objects hidden inside a designer dining table.
- Financial records showing **large payments from known art collectors** to accounts linked to Dr. Morales.
- Encrypted emails between Morales and the logistics company discussing the **"special contents."**

**Forensic Analysis:** Analysis of the museum's inventory records revealed **discrepancies** that matched the shipment dates. Dr. Morales had been **replacing authentic artifacts with high-quality replicas**, a change undetectable without expert examination.

**Resolution:** **Dr. Morales and her accomplices were arrested**. A large portion of the stolen artifacts was recovered, including the outer panel of a sarcophagus that gave the case its name. The network was **completely dismantled**.

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## File Case #13

**Case ID:** 250N **Case Title:** The "'Spark' Hunter" Case **Date:** Spate of crimes in 2023  
**Status:** Closed

**Crime Summary:** Several women reported being robbed by a man they met through **"Spark," a popular dating app**. The man would meet them at their apartments, and after gaining their trust, would subtly **drug them with a benzodiazepine** in their drink and steal valuables.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The suspect created **fake profiles** on "Spark" using model photos. He was charming and convincing. He always used the same opening line: **"Do you believe in destiny, or should I walk by again?"** After each robbery, he **deleted the profile** and created a new one.

### Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect: Esteban "El Encantador" (The Charmer) Pardo**, a con artist with a history of fraud.
- **Victim(s):** At least 6 women.

### Key Evidence:

- The **identical behavioral pattern** and **opening line**, reported by all victims.
- Analysis of drug residue in the victims' glasses.
- Despite using fake profiles, one victim recalled the suspect mentioning **working near a specific area of the city**.
- The suspect made a mistake: he used the **same coffee shop WiFi network** to create two of his fake profiles on different weeks.

**Forensic Analysis:** The cybercrime team worked with "Spark" to identify accounts created from the **same device MAC address**, even if the IPs were different. They cross-referenced this information with the **coffee shop's geolocation data**, which allowed them to obtain a short list of devices. One of the victims **recognized Esteban Pardo** in a series of photographs.

**Resolution: Esteban Pardo was arrested.** Several of the stolen items were found in his possession. The digital evidence, combined with victim recognition, led to his **conviction**.

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## File Case #14

**Case ID:** 007O **Case Title:** The "Sealed Room" Case **Date:** April 20, 2019 **Status:** Closed

**Crime Summary:** Tech magnate **Adrián Vega** was found dead in the **panic room** of his mansion. The room, lined with titanium, was **locked with multiple bolts from the inside**. The cause of death was **poisoning by a gaseous neurotoxin**.

**Modus Operandi (M.O.):** The murder was designed to look like a suicide or an impossible accident. The killer did **not force entry**. Instead, they exploited an intimate knowledge of the room's construction: they introduced the neurotoxin through the room's **independent ventilation system**, which had a hidden and supposedly secret exterior air inlet.

### Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect:** **Lucas Vega**, Adrián's disinherited son, who was a brilliant **graduate student in chemistry**.
- **Victim:** Adrián Vega.

### Key Evidence:

- Autopsy confirming death by a **rare synthetic neurotoxin**.
- Investigation revealing that **Lucas Vega had written his thesis on that very type of neurotoxic compound**.
- The original blueprints for the panic room, showing the ventilation inlet. It was discovered that Lucas had worked at the security company that installed it during a summer.
- Online purchases of **chemical precursors** to synthesize the toxin, made by Lucas under a false name but **shipped to a PO Box in his name**.

**Forensic Analysis:** Analysis of the ventilation system filter found **traces of the neurotoxin**. The cybercrime team traced the online purchases back to **Lucas Vega**, despite his attempts to conceal his identity.

**Resolution:** **Lucas Vega was charged with murder**. His motive was the inheritance, as his father planned to donate his entire fortune. He **confessed to the crime**, explaining in detail how he synthesized the poison and administered it remotely. He was sentenced to life in prison.